

TasteFlow Functional and Implementation Report

1. Product Overview

TasteFlow is a premium hospitality discovery platform designed for restaurants, hotels, cafés, beverage brands, event organizers, and local food experiences. The application is built as a modern React + TypeScript + Vite frontend with a premium visual identity, responsive layout, and multi-page flow. It presents a polished marketplace experience where consumers can discover businesses, compare offers, explore menus, and browse events, while merchants can manage public profiles, promotions, campaigns, and menu operations.

At the moment, the project is a front-end prototype with mock data, local storage behavior, and static interactions. It is not yet connected to a real backend, database, authentication layer, or payment system. The app clearly demonstrates the user experience and business logic it intends to support, and it provides a solid foundation for implementing real functionality.

The key concept of the platform is to bring hospitality discovery, sensory personalization, and business promotion into one ecosystem.

2. Current Functional Scope

2.1 Landing page and marketing funnel

The home page is a premium marketing landing page with:

- Brand hero section
- CTA buttons for Explore marketplace and Start business profile
- Social proof metrics such as venue score, monthly impressions, and hospitality categories
- Feature cards describing storefronts, menus, campaigns, and marketplace reach
- Featured business cards showing curated venues
- Premium design system with glassmorphism, dark mode, artistic cards, and soft hospitality styling

This is a conversion-focused landing page that is designed to attract two types of users:

1. Travelers, tourists, or local consumers looking for experiences
2. Business owners who want to create and manage a hospitality profile

Implementation for full functionality:

- Replace static mock stats with real analytics from the database
- Display top-performing venues using ranking logic based on rating, engagement, conversion, and location proximity
- Add A/B testing and tracking for CTA performance

- Connect the business signup CTA to a real onboarding flow with authentication and subscription selection

2.2 Marketplace discovery

The Discover page acts as the public marketplace where users can:

- Search by business name, city, or tags
- Filter by business type
- View a responsive grid of venues
- See a map preview with nearby business pins
- Browse offers and venue metadata

This functionality is implemented using a filtered list based on mock venue data and simple state management. It is a prototype of a geo-discovery marketplace.

Implementation for full functionality:

- Use a real search engine or database query layer with indexing for business name, city, category, and tags
- Add geolocation support using browser geolocation or user-selected city
- Use Mapbox, Google Maps, or Leaflet to render actual venue markers and clustering
- Support sorting by proximity, rating, event count, and newest offers
- Add pagination and lazy loading for large inventory
- Support filters like cuisines, dietary options, price range, events, and tourist suitability

2.3 Venue detail pages

Each venue has a dedicated public detail page driven by a route like `/venues/:venueId`.

The page shows:

- Venue banner design
- Business category and trust score
- City and country details
- Description and website
- Published menu items
- Upcoming events
- Contact option for the business

This gives the platform a public-facing storefront experience. It is a typical B2B hospitality profile page that helps potential customers assess the venue.

Implementation for full functionality:

- Query the venue from a database by ID
- Fetch related menu items and event records from a separate table or relation
- Add reviews and rating summaries
- Include SEO metadata, social preview cards, and structured business information
- Support explicit business contact forms, booking requests, or reservation actions

2.4 Menu discovery

The Menus page displays a catalog of menu items with cards showing:

- Name
- Category
- Price
- Dietary tags
- Description
- Flavor profile and recommendations

This is a discovery layer for the platform; it is not limited to a single venue but acts as a marketplace of available menu experiences.

Implementation for full functionality:

- Store menu items in a database linked to businesses and language variants
- Add multi-language menu content and local pricing support
- Include image uploads, allergen data, and availability schedules
- Support filtering by dietary preference, cuisine, drink type, meal occasion, and price range
- Offer menu bookmarking or favorites for users

2.5 Event discovery and planning

The Events page lists tasting events and experiences with event cards containing:

- Title
- Date
- Seats
- Theme
- Pricing
- Venue metadata

The venue detail page also surfaces relevant events.

Implementation for full functionality:

- Add real event CRUD operations in the dashboard
- Support reservation flows with seat inventory and time slots
- Add QR check-in and digital tickets
- Add recurring event scheduling and event calendars
- Allow event promotion to local audiences and nearby tourists
- Add reminders, cancellation policies, and confirmation emails

2.6 Business registration

The BusinessRegisterPage includes a form that collects information such as:

- Business name
- Business type
- City
- Website
- Business objective and promotion goals

The design suggests a first-step onboarding flow where merchants join the marketplace by creating a profile.

Implementation for full functionality:

- Use a real multi-step onboarding wizard
- Add authentication via Clerk, Auth0, Supabase Auth, or similar
- Save business settings to a table with profile status, onboarding progress, and subscription plan
- Verify business ownership via domain validation or manual approval
- Add optional business verification, location data, and legal info
- Support invitation-based onboarding and team permissions

2.7 Merchant dashboard

The DashboardPage is the core merchant workspace. It contains:

- Overview metrics grid
- Business profile editing form
- Menu management list
- Tasting events listing

- Offers and marketing campaign section

It acts like a lightweight SaaS dashboard for hospitality businesses.

Implementation for full functionality:

- Add secure authenticated routes using a protected layout
- Create CRU D operations for profile, menu items, campaigns, events, and offers
- Add analytics charts: impressions, conversions, leads, reservations, and revenue
- Use server-side validation and permissions per business account
- Support role-based access for admin, manager, or marketing staff
- Add AI-generated campaign ideas and automated optimization recommendations

2.8 Pricing and subscriptions

The Pricing page displays three plan tiers:

- Starter
- Growth
- Pro

Each plan includes features and a selection state that links to a contact or plan-specific path.

Implementation for full functionality:

- Integrate Stripe or Paddle for subscriptions
- Add plan gating based on business features and limits
- Support monthly billing, tax, discounts, and invoice generation
- Add management portal for plan upgrade, downgrade, and cancellation
- Use webhook-driven sync with your backend for license and entitlement updates

2.9 Contact and lead generation

The Contact page includes:

- A contact card with email information
- A form with request type and message
- Mailto link generation for outgoing message creation

This is a lead-generation page that allows visitors to reach the business or support team.

Implementation for full functionality:

- Use a backend endpoint to submit contact requests into a CRM or ticket system
- Validate spam and bot protection
- Store leads with source, campaign ID, and business interest type
- Trigger email notifications to the sales or support team
- Add response tracking and follow-up reminders

2.10 Personal palate intelligence

The PalatePage is one of the most distinctive features of the app. It allows users to:

- Save tastings with sensory scores
- Score dimensions such as acidity, body, tannin, sweetness, and aroma
- Keep notes on what they tasted
- Track recent tastings
- Generate a personalized palate profile
- Receive menu recommendations based on taste history

This is a personalized recommendation module similar to a taste-preference engine.

Implementation for full functionality:

- Store tasting entries in a user profile database
- Add a proper recommendation algorithm using weighted similarity or collaborative filtering
- Support categories such as wine, tea, coffee, food, and cocktails
- Use personalized scoring across more tasting dimensions
- Add visualization tools for taste trends over time
- Build recommendation confidence metrics and explainability for each suggestion

2.11 Concierge assistant

The ConciergePage is a conversational recommendation panel that:

- Accepts user questions
- Uses profile data to answer based on a user taste profile
- Suggests the best menu item or tasting path
- Provides conversational guidance about tasting and event experiences

This is a lightweight AI-like interaction layer.

Implementation for full functionality:

- Connect to an LLM API such as OpenAI, Azure OpenAI, or another model provider

- Ground the recommendations in the user's real palate data and catalog metadata
- Add conversation memory, intent detection, and structured retrieval
- Support multilingual responses based on user locale
- Add guardrails for unsafe or misleading recommendations

2.12 Blend Lab

The BlendLabPage allows a user to:

- Select two catalog items
- Adjust their mix ratio
- Preview a blended taste profile
- Save a custom blend configuration locally

This is a simulation tool for experimenting with flavor combinations.

Implementation for full functionality:

- Store saved blends per user account
- Add real product data and blend recommendations from sensory analytics
- Support image thumbnails, blending notes, and recommended pairings
- Add a more advanced algorithm based on ingredient categories and flavor vectors
- Allow creation of custom recipes for beverage, coffee, or food pairing experiences

2.13 Localization and language switching

The app includes a language switcher and a structured messages catalog with English, Swedish, French, and Spanish examples.

Implementation for full functionality:

- Use a robust i18n framework such as i18next or next-intl
- Manage translations in JSON or locale files
- Support regional formatting for date, time, and currency
- Add language detection based on geolocation or browser preference
- Ensure full UI translation for all forms, dashboards, pricing, and marketing pages

2.14 Currency and theme support

The app supports a currency switcher and toggles between light and dark theme modes.

Implementation for full functionality:

- Store a user preference in database or local storage
- Format prices according to region and locale
- Support payments in specific currencies and conversion APIs
- Use theme persistence with system defaults and accessibility compliance

3. Core Data Model for a Fully Functional Version

The current app relies on mock data, but the real product needs a normalized schema. A production-ready backend should model entities such as:

Users

- id
- name
- email
- role
- locale
- currency
- contact preferences
- created_at

Businesses

- id
- owner_user_id
- name
- type
- description
- city
- country
- latitude
- longitude
- website
- status
- onboarding_progress
- plan_id

Menus and menu items

- id
- business_id

- name
- category
- description
- price
- currency
- dietary_tags
- is_active
- seo_slug

Events

- id
- business_id
- title
- description
- date
- start_time
- duration
- seats_available
- price
- currency
- is_recurring
- location

Offers and campaigns

- id
- business_id
- title
- description
- discount_type
- discount_value
- start_date
- end_date
- audience_target

Tasting entries

- id

- user_id
- sample_name
- notes
- scores
- created_at

Reviews and ratings

- id
- user_id
- business_id
- rating
- review_text
- created_at

4. Architecture Needed for Full Functionality

Frontend

- React + TypeScript + Vite
- React Router for route-based app navigation
- Tailwind CSS for styling
- React Query or TanStack Query for API data fetching and caching
- Zustand or Redux Toolkit for app state management
- Form libraries such as React Hook Form + Zod for validation
- Map library such as Mapbox GL or Leaflet

Backend

- Node.js + NestJS, Next.js API routes, or a .NET API backend depending on the company stack
- PostgreSQL as the primary relational database
- Prisma or TypeORM for data modeling and migrations
- Supabase or Firebase for quick deployment if a lighter stack is preferred
- Authentication service with access control and session management

Search and discovery

- PostgreSQL full-text search and indexing for core queries
- Redis caching for popular search results
- Geospatial indexing for nearby venue queries
- Search API and filter support for category, location, dietary tags, and price

Payment and billing

- Stripe Checkout and Stripe Customer Portal
- Webhooks for subscription validation and billing events
- Plan limits enforced on the backend rather than only in the frontend

AI and personalization

- LLM integration for concierge responses
- Recommendation engine based on taste similarity and normalized vector scores
- Analytics pipeline for improving personalization over time

Security

- JWT or session-based auth for users and businesses
- Server-side validation for all CRUD operations
- Rate limiting for public search and contact endpoints
- Role permissions and resource ownership checks

5. Full User Experience Flow

Consumer flow

1. User lands on the homepage and reads the value proposition.
2. User opens the marketplace and searches for venues or menus.
3. User filters by type, rating, price, and distance.
4. User opens a venue profile to read reviews, menu items, and event info.
5. User saves or bookmarks a venue or specific menu item.
6. User logs tasting experiences and builds a taste profile.
7. User asks the concierge for recommendations.
8. User reserves or buys tickets to events if available.

Business flow

1. Business owner clicks Start business profile.
2. Owner enters profile details and verifies the business.
3. Owner submits dashboard information and chooses a plan.
4. Owner creates menus, events, and marketing offers.
5. Merchant can publish campaign promotions and track market performance.
6. Owner reviews analytics and conversion metrics.
7. The business can update pricing, inventory, and local event schedules.

6. Key Business Logic to Implement

- Search ranking based on user location, rating, freshness, and promotional activity
- Lead scoring and conversion metrics for business adoption
- Demand-based recommendations and event targeting
- Profile completeness scoring for onboarding flow
- Reservation management with seat limits and inventory control
- Real-time updates for event availability and offer expiration
- AI-generated concierge answers that are grounded in actual user and business data

7. Suggested Roadmap

Phase 1: MVP launch

- Real auth and business onboarding
- Database-backed venue and menu list
- Event creation and list management
- Contact forms and admin dashboards
- Basic analytics and plan selection

Phase 2: Discovery and personalization

- Geospatial search
- User taste profiles and recommendations
- Offer targeting and campaign management
- Reservation and ticketing flows
- Reviews and social proof

Phase 3: Growth and automation

- AI concierge assistant
- Dynamic ranking and recommendation engine
- CRM and lead automation
- Stripe billing and upgrade flows
- Dashboard automation and campaign optimization

8. Conclusion

TasteFlow is already a compelling and well-designed concept platform. Its real strength is that it combines several high-value hospitality workflows into one product: discovery, menu browsing, event marketing, business onboarding, personalization, AI guidance, and merchant dashboard management.

The application is currently a front-end mockup, but it is structurally ready for full production functionality. To complete it, the project needs a real backend, auth system, databases, search, payment integration, recommendation engine, and production-grade content and analytics workflows. With those additions, the current UX can become a fully functional hospitality marketplace and SaaS platform.

This document outlines the current functionality and the practical implementation blueprint necessary to evolve the app from a polished prototype into a production-ready product.